

BRIAN VALDEZ

WORK EXPERIENCE

Summit Digital — Senior Mobile Engineer

October 2008 to February 2026 | Mooreville

- Refactored the billing module behind a feature flag, eliminating 25% of recurring production incidents.
- Drove the team's adoption of trunk-based development, reducing merge conflicts and lead time by 70%.
- Mentored 40 junior engineers, ran weekly design reviews, and authored the team's onboarding guide.
- Owned the customer-facing API end to end on Vue.js, from schema design through on-call support.
- Set the service-level objectives for 8 services and built the dashboards the team still runs on.

Platform Engineer, Foxglove Media

October 2004 to June 2008 | Jamieborough (Remote)

- Led the migration of a legacy monolith to Node.js, taking deployments from fortnightly to 20 per day.
- Cut CI build times by 60% by parallelising the Docker pipeline and caching dependency layers.
- Built a reusable Vue.js component library adopted by 12 product teams, removing months of duplicated work.
- Introduced contract testing with Java, lifting coverage from 10% to 96% and cutting integration bugs.

Software Engineer, Clearwater Systems

December 2001 to May 2004 | Terryside (Hybrid)

- Partnered with product to scope and deliver 6 major releases, each behind staged rollouts.
- Hardened authentication flows in Go after a security review, closing 30 findings before audit.
- Rewrote the search path in Go, dropping median response from 600ms to 80ms for 4M monthly users.

Mobile Engineer

DeepMind | February 2001 to August 2001 | Donnaport

- Designed and shipped GraphQL services handling 40k requests per minute, cutting p99 latency from 900ms to 40ms.
- Replaced a third-party dependency with an in-house Node.js module, saving \$6k per year in licence fees.
- Reduced technical debt on a legacy component that had blocked 12 previous attempts.

Junior Mobile Engineer, Beacon Interactive

February 2000 to September 2000 | North Brandon (Hybrid - 2 days on-site)

- Took over an unowned service, documented it and brought it back under SLO.
- Interviewed and onboarded 5 new hires, shaping the hiring bar for the team.
- Represented the team in cross-functional planning with product, design and support.

ACADEMIC HISTORY

Master, Data Science

University of Toronto | 1999 to 2000

GPA 3.8/4.0

Thesis: "Drift detection for production forecasting models"

Bachelor, Data Science

University of Toronto | 1995 to 1998

SKILLS

Git (12 yr exp), Docker (22 yr exp), Redis (7 yr exp), GraphQL (16 yr exp), React (10 yr exp), Java (9 yr exp), Python (10 yr exp), pytest (5 yr exp), Go (2 yr exp), Node.js (11 yr exp), C# (7 yr exp), Vue.js (21 yr exp), Cypress (14 yr exp), FastAPI (4 yr exp), dbt (17 yr exp), MongoDB (3 yr exp)

PROJECTS

Conference talk

Spoke on FastAPI in production at a regional meetup, ~20 attendees.

Recipe search engine

Full-text search over a scraped recipe corpus using Go; learned more about ranking than about cooking.

TRAINING & CERTIFICATIONS

Professional Data Engineer — Google Cloud, 2018

AWS Certified Developer - Associate — Amazon Web Services, 2024

Azure Fundamentals (AZ-900) — Microsoft, 2023

HOBBIES & INTERESTS

Open-source contribution, Trail running, Chess, Urban sketching